



MATERIALS SCIENTIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Materials scientists study the composition and structure of matter at microscopic level. Using this specialized knowledge, they develop materials with new properties. The silicon chips used in computers, the carbon fiber frames of racing bikes, and the concrete used in skyscrapers have all been developed and tested by materials scientists.



SALARY

Newly qualified scientist ★★☆☆☆

Senior materials scientist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Good opportunities across a wide range of industries • Industry currently facing a skills shortage • Most jobs with large companies with over 1,000 employees

CAREER PATHS

Material scientists usually specialize in working with one type of material, which will govern their career direction. You could, for example, develop lightweight composite materials for the aerospace industry or environmentally-friendly plastics for food packaging. You can usually focus on research or manufacturing, or move into a management role later in your career.

MATERIALS TECHNICIAN With a high-school degree and strong understanding of science and mathematics, you may find work as a materials technician with a large company. You can then study for a degree while on the job.

GRADUATE You will need a degree in a relevant subject, such as chemistry, physics, or materials engineering. Some employers will expect a higher degree in your chosen area of specialization.



RESEARCH SCIENTIST

Uses an advanced knowledge of physics and chemistry to study the structure of solids, and to design, produce, and test new materials.



MATERIALS SCIENTIST

As a qualified materials scientist, you can work in diverse industries, from metal foundries to nanotechnology—the design and engineering of machines on a microscopic scale.

